



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*śruti-smṛti-purāṇādi-pāñcarātra-vidhiṃ vinā |
aikāntikī harer bhaktir utpātāyaiva kalpyate | |
mad-arpaṇaṃ niṣphalaṃ vā sāttvikaṃ nija-karma yat |
rājasam phala-saṅkalpaṃ hiṃsā-prāyādi tāmasam | | [BhP 11.25.23]
kaivalyaṃ sāttvikaṃ jñānaṃ rajo vaikalpikaṃ tu yat |
prākṛtaṃ tāmasaṃ jñānaṃ man-niṣṭhaṃ nirguṇaṃ smṛtam | |*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

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GURU'S INTERPRETATION

It emphasizes that devotion to the Divine, devoid of scriptural guidance (śruti, smṛti, purāṇas), is ultimately disruptive. True devotion, the verse suggests, must be rooted in understanding and wisdom, not blind faith.

The passage clarifies how different types of actions relate to these gunas. Actions performed without offering them to the Divine are rendered fruitless, even if they are seemingly virtuous (sattvic). Actions driven by a desire for specific results are considered rajasic, fueled by passion and attachment. And actions that are predominantly violent or harmful are classified as tamasic, born from ignorance and delusion.

Similarly, knowledge itself is categorized. Sattvic knowledge leads to liberation (kaivalyam), offering a clear and unifying understanding. Rajasic knowledge is fragmented and uncertain, leading to doubt and confusion. Tamasic knowledge is superficial and materialistic, keeping us bound to the physical world. True knowledge, however, transcends these gunas; it is rooted in unwavering devotion to the Divine. This is the knowledge that leads to ultimate liberation.

In our modern lives, this understanding is crucial. We are constantly bombarded with choices and information, and it can be difficult to discern what is truly beneficial. By understanding the qualities of sattva, rajas, and tamas, you can evaluate your actions and motivations, and strive to cultivate sattvic qualities in your life. Offer your work as a form of devotion. Seek knowledge that leads to understanding and unity. And avoid actions that are driven by selfish desires or harmful intentions. This path, guided by devotion and wisdom, leads to true fulfillment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you striving to purify your actions and thoughts through devotion and selflessness, and how might you cultivate more sattvic qualities in your daily life?